

NORMAN TIPPER RICHINS AND ELVA MARY FOWLER AND LEOLA MANZEL FARR

Norman Tipper Richins was born April 3, 1905, at his parent's home in Henefer, the seventh son born to them.



**Elva and Norman's Wedding Picture –
15 November 1927**

With such a large family of boys Hattie had a lot of work to do. Norman remembers getting up early before he went to elementary school to help his mother with the washing as he pushed the handle back and forth on the washer. He turned the cream separator and then worked to churn the cream into butter. There was no electricity at that time or inside bathroom. Baths were only on Saturday nights with warm water heated on a coal stove. Two or three of the children took turns using the same water before it was dumped and filled for the next round.

Norman sometimes stayed with his grandmother, Esther, one of Charles Richins' plural wives who was left to raise her family alone most of the time. He helped her and talked of his love for her throughout his lifetime. This early training in his home was a contributing factor to his own concern and love for his family and his fellowmen.

One of Norman's greatest interests at school was sports. He threw the shot-put further than anyone else when he was a senior. His favorite sport was basketball where he played center on the first team. Like others in his family he enjoyed music. He played the trombone, sang the lead in school operas, and was in the glee club at North Summit. He also toured with a singing group while attending LDS Business College. He sang with the Tabernacle Choir one winter.

Norman dated a number of young women but mostly Elva Mary Fowler. Elva had worked for Alma and Hattie during the summers from the time she started high school until she graduated. She wrote that she learned many things from Hattie about homemaking and always had a great love for her. A year after she graduated from high school, on November 15, 1927, Norman and Elva were married in the Salt Lake Temple by Apostle George F. Richards. Both of their mothers went by train with them to Salt Lake City for their marriage. A reception was held in the Henefer recreation hall on their return.

After Norman and Elva were married they moved into two rooms of the Joseph Ovard home. Two years later they built a new home on property purchased from Ben Hopkins. About the only furniture they had was an oblong table Norman had built in shop, a little rocking chair and a china closet. Elva was an excellent housekeeper, a hard worker, and a loving wife and mother. She had a green thumb and loved to work outdoors.

Norman worked with his father and in his own livestock business all his life. He loved the sheep and although he had a few dairy cows and beef cattle he preferred being with the sheep and spent many days with them. He said he could never remember his father paying him a wage while he was growing up, but that his father gave him money when he needed it to go to a show or dance. One year he told Norman to select 75 ewe lambs from the herd and mark them as his own. He was still working with his father when the depression hit. Times were hard then so he worked on the state road for two summers.

Mary "F" Richins was born to Norman and Elva on September 5, 1928 in her Grandmother Fowler's big bedroom. James Alden was born on December 21, 1930 in the same big bed room. Norman was on the desert

both at the time Alden was born and on April 30, 1934 when Lorraine was born. Grant Norman was born July 31, 1938 and Myron Alma on June 27, 1945. Myron was the only one of the children not born at Grandma Fowler's home. His birth was in the Coalville Hospital.

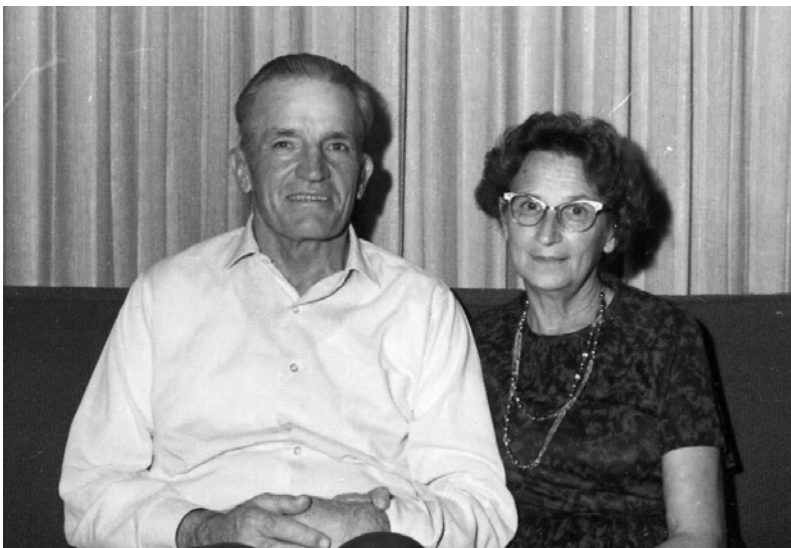
It can truly be said of Norman and Elva that they loved God and served their fellowmen. They accepted church callings and supported each other in these callings. They set a good example for their children. Norman served as a Sunday School superintendent, YMMIA president and as a stake missionary. He served as bishop of Henefer Ward for eleven years and was on the stake high council for 18 years. Norman and Elva were called as Salt Lake Temple workers in 1960 and served weekly until 1965. On June 21,



1950- Grant, Norman, Elva, Myron. Mary. Alden and Lorraine

1970, Norman was sustained as stake patriarch, a position he held until his death. He felt very humble in this position and fasted and prayed before giving each blessing.

Norman was active in civic affairs being elected to the North Summit School Board for 14 years. He served on the Farmers Home Administration Committee, County Soil Conservation Committee, Soil Conservation Service and was a member of the Henefer Pony Express riding group.



Norman and Leola at the time of their marriage in 1966
only 21 months old.

Elva held various church positions including Stake Relief Society president. She was an active member of the Daughters of the Utah Pioneers and loved the Lord all her life. She passed away of Leukemia on August 1, 1965, when only 56 years old.

Norman was lonely after Elva's death. One day he renewed acquaintances with Leola Manzel Farr, whom he had known during his youth. She had lost her husband, Kenneth Lee Farr. Leola and Kenneth had four children, a daughter, Leola, and three sons, Kenneth Lee Jr., Owen Talmage and David. Owen died when

Norman and Leola were married for time in the Salt Lake Temple November 3, 1966. They were called on a mission to Oregon and served there from January 1974 until July 1975. They also served as ordinance workers in the Ogden Temple. Both Norman and Leola were honored by their families and friends when they each celebrated their 80th birthdays.

Norman passed away May 15, 1987, after a few years of heart problems. He was buried next to Elva in the Henefer Cemetery. Anyone who knew Norman couldn't help but feel that he was a successful man. He had the love of God in his life, a large posterity who loved him and an ever greater number of friends who thought highly of him.

Leola continued to love Norman's family until she broke her hip and died suddenly on November 17, 1992, while still in the McKay Dee Hospital. Her funeral was held in Henefer according to the program she had planned. She was buried next to her husband in the Ogden City Cemetery.--Lorraine R. Heiner and Alden Richins, April 1993.



1985-Norman's 80th birthday- Norman, Leola, Myron, Grant, Lorraine, Alden & Mary